Guitar Exercises - Section XIV, Level 95

Scaffolded Repertoire Integration

Form • Harmony • Groove • Lead Roles • Cues • Complete-Piece Performance

Level 95 of the fixed 105-level core curriculum. Section XIV begins here. HARD STOP after Level 105.

The curriculum now stops introducing major new guitar systems. The task is to apply the systems already learned to complete music, with progressively less instructional scaffolding.

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A	Repertoire preflight and difficulty mapping	96
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I	Forty-bar scaffolded complete-piece capstone	320
J	Performance review and next-pass plan	64
	TOTAL	1456

Core rule: a complete, musically convincing performance outranks a technically impressive fragment.

Reference - Repertoire Integration Stack

Layer	Question
Form	Where am I, and what comes next?
Harmony	What is the functional chord map?
Groove	What makes this piece move?
Role	Am I supporting, answering, or leading?
Targets	Which notes explain the harmony?
Expression	Which articulations fit the phrase?
Cues	What signals the next section or role?
Recovery	What is the simplest version that preserves the song?

The student learns the piece from the top of this stack downward, then performs it from the bottom upward without losing the form.

Module A - Repertoire Preflight

Category	Low difficulty	Medium	High
Form	repeating 4-bar loop	multiple sections	irregular/extended form
Harmony	diatonic triads	7ths/secondary dominants	modulation/chromatic harmony
Rhythm	straight eighths	syncopation/shuffle	style changes/odd grouping
Technique	open/barre chords	triads/fills	independent voices/advanced lead
Lead	pentatonic targets	chord-tone phrases	modulation/altered targets
Expression	basic vibrato	bends/slides	compound articulation arc

Choose repertoire where no more than two categories are 'High' at once. The goal is integration, not selecting the hardest possible song.

Module A - Skill-to-Song Requirement Matrix

Requirement	Already secure?	Needs rehearsal?	Simplification
Chord vocabulary			shell/triad
Tempo/groove			quarter/eighth skeleton
Section changes			roots only at transition
Lead vocabulary			target notes only
Ear/transcription			use landmarks
Expression			plain targets
Memory			section cue card
Recovery			root + melody landmark

Complete this matrix before intensive rehearsal. A difficult passage should have a planned fallback version before the first full take.

Module B - Form and Landmark Mapping

Pass	Task
1	Speak section names over the recording/backing track.
2	Count bars in every section.
3	Mark first chord of each section.
4	Mark one melodic/rhythmic landmark per section.
5	Mark every transition cue.
6	Perform roots only while saying section names.
7	Remove chart; reconstruct form from landmarks.

The form map should fit on one page. If it does not, reduce details until the large-scale structure is obvious.

Module C - Harmony Reduction

Pass	Harmony representation
1	Roots only
2	Roman numerals / function
3	Triads or shells
4	Performance voicings
5	One alternate voicing per section
6	One simplified emergency voicing per section

The player must be able to perform the complete piece with roots, shells, or full voicings. This creates a recovery ladder rather than one brittle arrangement.

Module C - Voicing Assignment by Section

Section role	Preferred first voicing test	Reason
Intro	sparse triad/shell	leaves room for entrance
Verse	middle/upper partials	avoids bass/vocal masking
Pre-chorus	rising inversion/register	creates lift
Chorus	wider/full voicing	increases density
Bridge	new register or texture	contrast
Solo	supporting shells / fewer attacks	leaves lead space
Outro	reduced or sustained voicing	clarifies ending

These are arrangement starting points, not mandatory style rules.

Module D - Groove Reconstruction

Pass	Play only
1	Quarter-note pulse / foot
2	Primary attacks
3	Note lengths and releases
4	Ghosts/mutes
5	Bass/drum interaction
6	Complete rhythm guitar part
7	Same groove with simplified chord voicings

If the groove disappears when the chord extensions are removed, the rhythm has not been isolated clearly enough.

Module D - Groove Identity Audit

Variable	Question
Subdivision	Straight, swing, shuffle, or mixed?
Note length	Sustained, medium, clipped, percussive?
Accent	Where are the strongest attacks?
Register	Where does guitar sit relative to bass?
Density	How many meaningful contacts per bar?
Space	Where does guitar intentionally not play?
Section change	What changes when chorus/bridge arrives?

Answer these without naming the genre. The goal is to describe what the guitar actually does.

Module E - Lead Targets and Fill Windows

Role	Rule
Structural lead	land chord tone on section/chord landmark
Fill	finish before next structural rhythm attack
Answer	preserve rhythm or contour of preceding phrase
Climax	one planned expressive peak per phrase arc
Transition	lead into next chord/section target
Recovery	nearest chord tone, then simplify

For each section write no more than three mandatory lead targets. Everything between them may remain flexible.

Module E - Expression Assignment

Section	Maximum expressive focus
Intro	one tone/texture choice
Verse	one recurring articulation
Pre-chorus	one rising intensity device
Chorus	one stronger articulation family
Bridge	one contrasting tone/register
Solo	planned peak + release
Outro	one final resolution behavior

Do not assign a unique trick to every bar. Repetition creates identity.

Module F - Transition Loops and Cues

Loop	Rehearsal unit
1	last bar Intro + first bar Verse
2	last bar Verse + first bar Pre
3	last bar Pre + first bar Chorus
4	last bar Chorus + first bar Bridge
5	last bar Bridge + first bar Solo
6	last bar Solo + first bar Final Chorus
7	last bar Final Chorus + Outro
8	final cadence + release

Each transition must preserve chord, groove, register, dynamic, and role. Rehearse the boundary more often than the middle of an already secure section.

Module F - Cue Response

Cue	Response
Head nod / visual	prepare next section without stopping current bar
Drum fill	reduce guitar density and enter new texture
Bass pickup	leave space; land destination chord
Held chord	prepare cutoff or extension
Extra bar	repeat minimal groove without losing form
Early cue	move section only if ensemble cue is authoritative
Missed cue	continue current form until next recoverable landmark

The player must know whether the arrangement follows fixed bar count or live ensemble cue priority.

Module G - Three-Layer Performance Assembly

Layer	Complete take
1. Skeleton	roots + section landmarks only
2. Performance rhythm	full accompaniment, no lead fills
3. Complete role	accompaniment + fills + lead targets + expression
4. Reduced take	remove 50% of fills/ornaments
5. Memory take	no chart
6. Recovery take	partner/randomizer introduces one disruption

Do not perfect each section indefinitely before attempting a full take. Complete performances reveal integration failures that isolated practice hides.

Module H - Study 1 - Groove-led piece

| G | D | Em | C | G | D | C | D | Am | C | G | D | G | C | D | G |

Form: A8-B4-A'4. Focus: stable rhythm, one fill every 4 bars, register lift in B.

Pass	Requirement
1	form + roots
2	groove only
3	performance voicings
4	lead targets/fills
5	expression/dynamics
6	one uninterrupted memory take

Module H - Study 2 - Harmony/lead piece

| Cmaj7 | A7 | Dm7 | G7 | Cmaj7 | E7 | Am7 | G7 | Dm7 | G7 | Cmaj7 | A7 | Dm7 | G7 | Cmaj7 | Cmaj7 |

Form: A8-B8. Focus: secondary-dominant targets, guide tones, restrained expressive peak in bars 13-14.

Pass	Requirement
1	form + roots
2	groove only
3	performance voicings
4	lead targets/fills
5	expression/dynamics
6	one uninterrupted memory take

Module I - Forty-Bar Scaffolded Complete-Piece Capstone

Bars	Section	Harmony	Groove role	Guitar role
1-4	Intro	Cmaj7-Am7-Dm7-G7	sparse	roots/shells
5-12	Verse A	Cmaj7-Am7-Dm7-G7 x2	steady pocket	middle voicings
13-16	Pre	Am7-D7-Gmaj7-D7	build	rising register
17-24	Chorus	Gmaj7-Cmaj7-Em7-D7 x2	open/full	wide voicings
25-28	Bridge	Em7-B7-Em7-A7	contrast	reduced texture
29-32	Solo	Dm7-G7-Cmaj7-A7	support + targets	shells/lead
33-36	Final Chorus	Gmaj7-Cmaj7-D7-Gmaj7	peak	full arrangement
37-40	Outro	Cmaj7-A7-Dm7-G7	release	reduce to final target

This original study functions like repertoire: learn form, reduce harmony, assign groove, add targets, rehearse transitions, then perform from memory. One restart maximum during early assembly; zero restarts on the final pass.

Module J - Performance Review and Next-Pass Plan

Category	0	1	2
Form/memory	lost	recovers	secure
Harmony	wrong	functional	confident
Groove	unstable	functional	stylistic
Transitions	break	mostly	seamless
Role/space	overplays	usable	intentional
Lead targets	missed	mostly	clear
Expression	random	some arc	phrase-driven
Recovery	restart	simplifies	seamless

Pass Level 95: 14/16 or better on two separate days, with no zero in form/memory, groove, transitions, or recovery.

Next: Level 96 reduces the scaffolding: chart-to-performance repertoire reconstruction, selective transcription, voicing choices, style matching, and independent rehearsal planning.

Fixed roadmap: Levels 95-99 Repertoire Integration; 100-104 Composition; Level 105 Final Musicianship Capstone. HARD STOP after Level 105.